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Google has allowed users to insert emojis while writing in Google Docs.
<https://digit.in/sep22-49>



Vivo Y35 launched in India

Vivo Y35 is available in India priced at ₹18,499. It is powered by the Snapdragon 680 SoC.
<https://digit.in/sep22-50>

JBL Tune 230NC

High on bass, decent overall

The TWS market has become overly competitive. Especially when it comes to the sub-₹6K price bracket, the competition is even more cutthroat. Nothing has their Ear (1)s, and brands like OnePlus are also out there with their Buds Z2. With JBL coming in with their Tune230NC TWS earbuds, things have gotten even more interesting. Let's see how they fare in this crowded segment.

BUILD AND FIT

The JBL Tune230NC has a matte black charging case that sports aesthetic touches that would match a Japanese sports car. The earbuds look equally appealing. The case is made up of a material that feels super premium to touch and doesn't attract fingerprints.

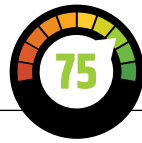
The earbuds' tips have a tasteful presence of JBL's signature orange colour. They have a long stem, which does not add much weight to the earbuds, with an LED indicator on top.

The earbuds fit well in the ears and held well through the 'head-shake' test. They are lightweight and can be customised to fit different ear sizes.

FEATURES

There is not much to complain about the JBL Tune230NC when it comes to the features department. They have touch controls on the stem which are adequate. However, when we look at the Nothing Ear (1) earbuds, which also have volume controls on their substantially smaller stem, we feel that JBL could have done a bit more here. The controls can be customised via the JBL Headphones app that adds a lot to the overall experience.

In terms of noise cancelling, they make up for the lost ground against their competitors. JBL Tune230NC feature great active noise cancel-



DESIGN.....	69
PERFORMANCE.....	77
VALUE FOR MONEY.....	70
FEATURES.....	82



lation. The ANC on these earbuds took away most of the annoying sounds during our Mumbai local rides. Another thing that helped them rise high in the rankings was the fact that these come with fast pair, which let us connect to the Android devices with

ease. Adding to the ease of use was the compatibility with voice assistants.

PERFORMANCE

The performance of JBL Tune230NC is nothing to write home about. These earbuds failed to live up to our expectations. It wouldn't take an expert to notice the boosted bass response of these earbuds. This boosted bass cannibalises the mid frequencies, which greatly affects the music listening experience. We were thoroughly underwhelmed in songs like *Rescue Me* by *OneRepublic*, where the vocals are the part that we look out for. The bass was overpowering anything that the drivers were trying to push out apart from it. This even affected the overall bass response, too, as it caused the bass to be muddy and not crisp. We had to make changes to the EQ when daily driving the earbuds to get a pleasurable audio experience.

The earbuds in the same price bracket that was able to surpass these in terms of performance were the Nothing Ear (1). The Ear (1)'s bass response is much tamer than the Tune230NC, and that makes for a great

audio experience. The OnePlus Buds Z2 could have matched up but lost out on their mids and fell behind.

In terms of microphone audio quality, there wasn't much to say. These earbuds deliver as expected. During phone calls, the audio remained clear even in noisy environments, and the buds did a decent job of reducing ambient noise.

BATTERY LIFE

In terms of battery life, there was a pleasant surprise waiting for us. In our test, the battery life of these earbuds came out astonishingly close to the bold claims JBL had made. With ANC turned on and volume set to 50 per cent, these earbuds lasted about seven and a half hours, which is impressive.

JBL claims that with 10 minutes of charge, you can get enough battery for two hours of music playback.

VERDICT

The JBL Tune230NC TWS earbuds hold its ground well against its competitors. The build and design are solid, there are plenty of features packed into the device, and the performance is great after a bit of tweaking. The app also features a lot of customisation options which, when coupled with the battery life of these earbuds, make them a solid package. The Nothing Ear (1) would be the only pair that gets past it. But it was meant to be a standout product. Like is the case with a lot of JBL products, the overpowering bass prevents them from being an instant recommendation.

If we were to sum up our experience of using the Tune 230NC, it would be - heavy on bass and they fall short of the top spot in the race.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER SIZE (MM): 6 | FREQUENCY RESPONSE RANGE: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | EARPIECE WEIGHT (G): 10.2 | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | CHARGING TIME (HOURS FROM EMPTY): 2 | MAXIMUM MUSIC PLAY TIME WITH ANC OFF (HOURS): 10 | MAXIMUM MUSIC PLAY TIME WITH ANC ON (HOURS): 8

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